Sample Incident Report: Fictional Ransomware Intrusion

Note: this is a fictional report written for testing the Attack Anatomy pipeline. All names, dates and events are invented.

Summary

Between 11 April 2022 and 16 April 2022, a threat actor compromised a mid-sized company and deployed ransomware. This report describes the attacker's activity in the order it was observed.

Timeline of attacker activity

On 11 April 2022, the attacker gained initial access by logging in to the corporate VPN with stolen employee credentials, which is the use of Valid Accounts (T1078).

On 12 April 2022, the attacker ran PowerShell commands (T1059.001) on a workstation to download a second-stage payload from an external server.

On the same day, the attacker created a Scheduled Task (T1053.005) so that the payload would run again after every reboot.

On 13 April 2022, the attacker dumped credentials from LSASS Memory (T1003.001) on a file server using a credential-dumping tool.

Later on 13 April 2022, the attacker moved laterally to other servers using SMB/Windows Admin Shares (T1021.002) and PsExec.

On 15 April 2022, the attacker collected documents and sent them to a server they controlled using Exfiltration Over C2 Channel (T1041).

On 16 April 2022, the attacker deployed ransomware that encrypted files across the network, which is Data Encrypted for Impact (T1486).

Recommendations

Organizations should enforce multi-factor authentication on VPN accounts and monitor for unusual PowerShell activity.